

NEGOTIATING SKILLS FOR SUCCESS

GOALS OF THE EXERCISE

1. Maintain a program of recovery free from addiction and the negative effects of Attention-Deficit Disorder (ADD).
2. Demonstrate sustained attention and concentration for consistently longer periods of time.
3. Learn positive ways to resolve or manage interpersonal differences.

ADDITIONAL HOMEWORK THAT CAN BE APPLICABLE TO CLIENTS WHO EXPERIENCE PROBLEMS WITH ATTENTION-DEFICIT DISORDER, INATTENTIVE TYPE

- A Different Approach
- Analyzing Acting-Out Behavior
- From Recklessness to Calculated Risks
- Getting Organized
- Interest and Skill Self-Assessment
- Working toward Independence

ADDITIONAL PROBLEMS FOR WHICH THIS EXERCISE MAY BE USEFUL

- Occupational Problems
- Parent-Child Relational Problems
- Partner Relational Problems

SUGGESTIONS FOR PROCESSING THIS EXERCISE WITH THE CLIENT

The “Negotiating Skills for Success” activity is intended for clients who would benefit from learning negotiation skills to improve their relationships with others. This activity can be incorporated into role-playing in individual sessions or in groups. It can be applied to past problems with intimate, work, or peer relationships or to problems the client is currently experiencing. Follow-up could include assignments to practice the skills learned and report back to the therapist and treatment group on outcomes.

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Attention problems can cause difficulties in many situations, including relationships. Other people may not understand, and may be hurt or offended by your having difficulty staying focused and being easily distracted. Either issue—drifting attention or distraction—makes initiating and sustaining relationships difficult. Many people use addictive behaviors to cope with relationship problems caused by these symptoms.

This exercise will teach you a step-by-step approach to negotiating differences with others, and give you some tips on negotiating social situations and relationships.

1. Think of a recent conflict you've had with someone. How did you know that you and the other person were having difficulty or a difference of opinion? (Skill 1 in negotiating is deciding whether you and the other person are having a difficulty with each other, or if one of you is feeling uncomfortable or unhappy for an unrelated reason.)

2. Skill 2 in negotiation is telling the other person what you think about the problem—without criticizing. Did you share your thoughts about what you thought about the problem? _____ Were you able to do this without criticizing? _____ How did you express yourself? _____

3. Skill 3 in negotiation is asking the other person what he/she thinks about the problem. This may be the same, but is likely to be different from what you think. Were you able to let the other person share his/her opinion without interruption?

4. Skill 4 is listening openly to the other person's perceptions and feelings. Were you able to do this? _____ If not, what happened and what got in the way?

5. Skill 5 is thinking about why the other person might feel this way. This does not mean judging

his/her thoughts as right or wrong, but rather seeing the situation from his/her point of view. How successful were you in doing this? Write down your ideas about why this person had the thoughts and feelings he/she had.

6. Skill 6 is finding a compromise. What was the outcome of your conflict? What compromises would you be able to suggest today for the same conflict?

7. Do some self-evaluation, not in a spirit of judging yourself but learning whatever lessons you can. In reviewing your conflict situation, what did you learn about your negotiation style? What would you like to do differently? What would the other person in the conflict say about your negotiation style?

8. You've just worked on how you can manage conflict differently in current and future relationships. Beginning and maintaining relationships takes work and following through. Following are a few ideas about what you can do to succeed at this:

- Plan regular activities with others around shared interests—avoid frequent requests for last minute get-togethers.
- Learn to listen and pay attention and respond specifically to what is being said.
- Pay attention to small courtesies—remember birthdays, call or email to say “hi”, thank people for favors, and so on.
- Get organized—keep phone lists, use a calendar to log dates and commitments, and so forth.
- Others you can think of:

What are some areas that you can work on to maintain and improve existing relationships—either those you've just begun or those that you've had for some time?

Ask someone close to you for feedback about how well you pay attention and follow through in your relationship with him/her. Write this feedback in the following space and develop a plan for addressing any issues this person points out.

Be sure to bring this handout back to your next session with your therapist, and be prepared to talk about your thoughts and feelings about the exercise.